

Alexandra Barka

SOFTWARE ENGINEER · FRONTEND ENGINEERING · WEB ACCESSIBILITY · PRODUCT BUILDER

Amsterdam, Netherlands

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Building elegant, accessible and user-focused digital products.

Profile

Creative and detail-oriented software engineer with more than ten years of experience building user-focused web products across hospitality, music, streaming, communications and human-computer interaction. Combines deep React, TypeScript and JavaScript expertise with strong product judgement, accessibility practice and an eye for UI quality. Experienced in modernising frontend platforms, improving performance and reliability, mentoring engineers and partnering closely with Product, Design, Backend and QA.

Skills

Frontend	React, TypeScript, JavaScript, Next.js, HTML5, Redux, TanStack Query, TanStack Table, GraphQL, Zod
Styling & UI	CSS3, SASS, Tailwind CSS, Flexbox, Grid, Design Systems, Storybook, Figma
Quality	Jest, Vitest, Playwright, unit testing, integration testing, end-to-end testing, code reviews, frontend observability
Backend & APIs	Node.js, REST APIs, GraphQL APIs, C#, API integration
Engineering	Frontend architecture, performance, observability, Git, GitHub, GitLab, Sentry, New Relic, Coralogix
AI-assisted engineering	Claude Code, OpenAI Codex, prompt engineering, AI agents, MCP servers, reusable skills, human-in-the-loop development
Collaboration	Product engineering, cross-functional delivery, technical leadership, mentoring, agile

Experience

Mews

Amsterdam, Netherlands (Remote)

SOFTWARE ENGINEER

Aug. 2024 – Present

- Contributed across Finance, Billing, Accounting, and Events Management Systems (EMS), building products used daily by hotels to manage financial and event operations.
- Led the frontend development of the new City Ledger product, delivering Accounts Receivable capabilities including invoice management, payments, and payment reminders.
- Led the redesign of the quotation experience in EMS, simplifying one of the platform's core workflows and significantly improving quote creation and editing for customers.
- Modernized the EMS frontend by migrating legacy components to the design system, introducing stronger TypeScript typing, and delivering incremental architectural refactors that improved maintainability and developer velocity.
- Introduced unit testing across the EMS codebase and improved overall code quality through refactoring, validation improvements, and technical debt reduction.
- Acted as part of the customer issue rotation, investigating and resolving production issues quickly while improving system reliability and user experience.
- Leveraged AI-assisted engineering, including Claude Code, AI agents, MCPs, and custom skills to accelerate development, automate workflows, and improve engineering productivity.
- Collaborated closely with Product, Design, Backend, and QA teams to deliver high-quality features across hospitality, accounting, and event management domains.

Spotify

Amsterdam, Netherlands (Remote)

WEB ENGINEER II

Sep. 2022 – Aug. 2024

- Built and evolved internal marketing tools that enabled operators to create, manage, and optimise global campaigns supporting subscriber acquisition, engagement, and retention.
- Delivered end-to-end product features, collaborating with Product Managers, Designers, Backend Engineers, Data teams, and stakeholders from discovery through production.
- Led technical initiatives from planning to delivery, influencing architecture, engineering practices, and technical decisions across the team.
- Improved code quality and developer experience through refactoring, reusable components, automated testing, and ongoing technical improvements.
- Mentored junior engineers, onboarded interns, conducted code reviews, and promoted knowledge sharing across the engineering organisation.
- Contributed to Spotify's subscriber growth by building reliable internal products used daily by marketing teams worldwide.

WarnerMedia – HBO Max

Amsterdam, Netherlands (Remote)

FRONTEND ENGINEER

Jul. 2021 – Aug. 2022

- Built and delivered customer-facing features for HBO Max TV applications using JavaScript, TypeScript, JSX, and the Lightning TV Framework.
- Contributed to the international launch of HBO Max across Latin America and Europe, helping support millions of new subscribers and regional product rollouts.
- Migrated TV applications to a shared Design System, improving UI consistency, maintainability, scalability, and developer experience.
- Developed responsive, accessible user interfaces while contributing to organisation-wide accessibility (WCAG) initiatives to improve usability for all users.
- Collaborated closely with Product Managers, Designers, QA Engineers, and Backend Engineers to deliver high-quality features from concept through production.
- Improved code quality through refactoring, reusable components, code reviews, and modern engineering best practices.
- Helped deliver a reliable, scalable streaming experience for millions of users across multiple TV platforms and international markets.

MessageBird

Amsterdam, Netherlands (Remote)

FRONTEND ENGINEER

Aug. 2020 – Jul. 2021

- Worked in the onboarding and activation team as a React frontend engineer, balancing fast delivery with product reliability in an agile environment.
- Developed new onboarding and sign-up flows that reduced the time required for customers to connect with their users from days to minutes.
- Integrated the company design system and web-accessibility practices to deliver a consistent and inclusive customer experience.
- Participated in the support-engineer rotation, diagnosing and resolving customer problems with the wider team.

Earlier Experience

Strangelove Marketing Agency

Amsterdam, Netherlands

FRONTEND DEVELOPER

Feb. 2020 – Aug. 2020

- Built e-commerce applications and introduced API mocking and automated testing to accelerate frontend development.
- Developed internal automation tools, including invoice generation and a cookie scanning platform replacing a third-party service.

Yabbu

Amsterdam, Netherlands

FRONTEND DEVELOPER

Jul. 2019 – Jan. 2020

- Developed a cross-platform meeting management application while improving frontend performance and engineering processes.

UBITECH Ltd.

Athens, Greece

UI ENGINEER

Jul. 2018 – Jul. 2019

- Designed and built interfaces for public-sector, healthcare, aviation, and IoT applications, presenting work at the European Commission and DockerCon.

ICS-FORTH

Heraklion, Greece

RESEARCH & DEVELOPMENT ENGINEER

Jul. 2015 – Jul. 2018

- Conducted Human-Computer Interaction research, developing interactive systems showcased in museums and international conferences.

Education

University of Crete

Heraklion, Greece

M.Sc. IN COMPUTER ENGINEERING – INFORMATION SYSTEMS AND HUMAN-COMPUTER INTERACTION

Mar. 2016 – Feb. 2018

- Grade: 9.23/10. Major: Information Systems and Human-Computer Interaction.
- Thesis: Ulnify: A Designer Studio for Creating UI Mashups for Ambient Intelligence Environments, presented in November 2018 under the supervision of Constantine Stephanidis.
- Teaching Assistant in Data Structures (Panagiota Fatourou) and Modern Topics in Human-Computer Interaction (Constantine Stephanidis).

University of Crete

Heraklion, Greece

B.Sc. IN COMPUTER SCIENCE

Sep. 2011 – Feb. 2016

- Grade: 8.19/10. Volunteered as a teaching assistant in Computer Organisation and Introduction to Programming.
- Thesis: requirements analysis and development of a conceptual information-system model for food traceability, supervised by Irene Fundulaki and Dimitrios Plexousakis.